

ID: SOMA-M-P15

Title: Self-Compassion Soothing Touch

Duration: 10m 00s (692 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we'll explore the practice of soothing touch. The body often carries stories – of tension, of comfort, of fatigue, of rest. When we feel stress or struggle, our first response may be to turn inward with judgment or harshness. Yet, our body also remembers softness, and how to meet itself with care, when we make space for it. Soothing touch is a way of offering yourself the kind of care you might give to a loved one.

This practice is not about forcing yourself to feel better, nor is it about fixing what feels heavy. Instead, it is about extending a gesture of presence, warmth, and tenderness toward yourself. Different gestures work for different people. You might try a hand over the heart, arms around the belly, cupping your face, or clasping your hands.

Begin by finding a comfortable posture. You may sit or lie down, whichever allows your body to feel supported. Take a few moments to notice the surface beneath you – the chair, the bed, or the floor – and let yourself feel held by that support. Take a slow, deep breath in, and let it flow out. Allow your shoulders to soften, your jaw to release, and your hands to rest naturally. There is no rush, feel free to move at a kind pace.

You might also notice your breathing. Your breath may be fast, slow, shallow, or deep – any pattern is okay. Let your attention rest softly on the rhythm of your breath.

[Long Pause] (20s - Settling and breathing)

Now, bring one hand over the chest, over the area of your heart. Let your hand rest there lightly. Notice the gentle pressure, the heat of your palm, the rhythm beneath. Pay attention to the natural weight of your hand as it rests against your chest right now. If this feels comfortable for you, stay here for a few breaths. If it feels uncomfortable, know that you are free to adjust. If you wish, you may rest your hand at another part of the body.

[Long Pause] (20s - Hand on heart focus)

As your hand rests, bring attention to the sensation of contact. You might feel warmth, or a sense of grounding. You might notice a lot, or a little. Meet every experience that arrives with kindness.

[Long Pause] (20s - Sensation of contact)

If your mind wanders, notice this with ease, and return to the sensations at your hand. Let the touch be a reminder of presence and care.

[Long Pause] (20s - Sustaining presence)

Now, try a different gesture. Perhaps both hands resting on the belly. Feel the rise and fall of your breath beneath your hands.

You may also try gently cupping the sides of your face with one or both hands, as if you are holding yourself in a caring way. Notice how your palms and fingers meet your skin, the temperature, the sensation of contact. Let this gesture be tender.

Another option is to cross your arms and gently wrap your arms around your waist, as though you are being held. Allow the contact of the arms with the body to remind you of steadiness and a feeling of care.

[Short Pause] (10s - Exploring gestures)

As you rest with these gestures, notice which areas of the body respond to touch with a sense of comfort, warmth, or softness. Some areas may feel more sensitive, while others may feel more neutral. Treat all of these sensations with kindness without judgment.

You may also notice subtle shifts in mood, emotions, or energy as you engage in self-touch, and this is part of the experience. Take your time to sense which gesture feels most supportive for you. There is no right or wrong choice.

[Long Pause] (20s - Identifying support)

If strong emotions or feelings arise, hold them with care. There is no need to push them away. Your touch can be a companion to whatever is arising.

Continue to rest with the gesture that feels most nourishing. Take a few soothing breaths if you wish to. With each inhale, welcome softness. With each exhale, allow tension to ease. Let your body receive this care.

[Long Pause] (20s - Receiving care)

As we come toward closing this practice, release your hands slowly, allowing them to rest in the lap or by your side. Notice any shifts in the body.

[Final Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Thank you for your practice.

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